

JSS 3 NIGERIAN HISTORY – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 4: CONSTITUTION OF NIGERIA

1. The 1999 Constitution

The Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, 1999 (as amended) is the supreme law. It provides for federal structure, fundamental rights, separation of powers, and the organs of government (executive, legislature, judiciary).

2. Amendments

The constitution can be amended through a prescribed process involving the National Assembly and state Houses of Assembly. Amendments have addressed issues such as financial autonomy, electoral matters and other reforms. Debates continue about further changes (e.g. restructuring, resource control).

3. Importance

The constitution limits power, protects rights and provides rules for peaceful transfer of power. Respect for the constitution is essential for democracy and the rule of law.

4. Summary

The 1999 Constitution (as amended) is the foundation of Nigeria's democracy. Understanding and upholding it is a civic duty.

End of Topic 4